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Modular peripheral display input/output board with external scalar

Abstract

An information handling system peripheral display couples a midplane to a display panel back side with punched metal geometric structures that slide into midplane slots. A snap of the midplane couples to the back side when in a predetermined alignment. A timing controller board of the display panel has an edge connector that interfaces with a scalar board edge connector when the scalar board couples with slots at posts of the back side. The scalar board couples display cable ports to accept display information from an information handling system and extends the display cable ports out of openings of the midplane.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(1) The present invention relates in general to the field of information handling system peripheral displays, and more particularly to an information handling system modular peripheral display input/output board with external scalar.

Description of the Related Art

(2) As the value and use of information continues to increase, individuals and businesses seek additional ways to process and store information. One option available to users is information handling systems. An information handling system generally processes, compiles, stores, and/or communicates information or data for business, personal, or other purposes thereby allowing users to take advantage of the value of the information. Because technology and information handling needs and requirements vary between different users or applications, information handling systems may also vary regarding what information is handled, how the information is handled, how much information is processed, stored, or communicated, and how quickly and efficiently the information may be processed, stored, or communicated. The variations in information handling systems allow for information handling systems to be general or configured for a specific user or specific use such as financial transaction processing, airline reservations, enterprise data storage, or global communications. In addition, information handling systems may include a variety of hardware and software components that may be configured to process, store, and communicate information and may include one or more computer systems, data storage systems, and networking systems.

(3) Information handling systems integrate processing components that cooperate to process information. Stationary information handling systems, such as desktops and towers, operate the processing component in a stationary housing that interacts with an external power source and external peripheral devices, such as keyboard, mouse and display. Portable information handling systems have a portable housing that integrates a display and a power source to support mobile operations. Portable information handling systems allow end users to carry a system between meetings, during travel, and between home and office locations so that an end user has access to processing capabilities while mobile. Portable information handling systems typically also interact with end users through external peripheral devices, which tend to offer larger and more comfortable interfaces for the end user than integrated devices. A typical desktop environment will include a peripheral keyboard and peripheral mouse to accept end user inputs and a peripheral display to present information as visual images.

(4) Peripheral displays typically include a display panel with an array of pixels that generate a visual image from pixel values communicated by an information handling system. The array of pixels may include liquid crystal display (LCD) pixels that filter light from a white backlight source with red, green and blue liquid crystal material or organic light emitting diode (OLED) pixels that generate red, green and blue light when an electric field is applied. The display panel is fed a stream of pixel values across the array by a timing controller that scans the values to the array of pixels. The timing controller receives the pixel values from a scalar that adjusts the pixel values to a scale appropriate for the array of pixels, such as different resolutions that depend upon the visual image to be presented and the dimensions of the array of pixels in the display panel. A power board receives external power and applies the power to the display panel, backlight, timing controller and scalar. The visual images are typically communicated to the scalar through a standardized cable and connector, such as an HDMI, DisplayPort or USB Type-C interface. Typically, the display panel assembles in a flat panel configuration and couples to a display stand that holds the display assembly in a viewing position. For example, the backside of the display

assembly couples to a display stand with a VESA standard coupling interface.

(5) One difficulty with peripheral displays is that different sizes and arrangements of the components tend to result in complex designs. Peripheral displays are not typically upgradeable or repairable. When a display component goes bad, the complete display assembly and stand is typically disposed of as general waste without recycling. In particular, peripheral displays tend to have complex designs held together by screws that are difficult to disassemble so that efforts to recycle display components are not typically cost effective. A lack of modularity impedes repair and upgrade operations, which tends to result in premature disposal that exacerbates environmental electronic waste management problems. In addition, the use of unsustainable materials and manufacturing processes further contributes to environmental harm. For instance, even when a peripheral display is torn down for recycling, the lowest common component modules tend to include a variety of materials that are not compatible with each other for a recycle process. Design constraints and technical considerations make modularity and ease of repair difficult to achieve, especially in the display assembly backplane and midplane that have expensive critical components of a display monitor.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) Therefore, a need has arisen for a system and method which assembles peripheral displays in a modular manner that enhances repair, upgrade and recycling.

(7) In accordance with the present invention, a system and method are provided which substantially reduce the disadvantages and problems associated with previous methods and systems for assembly of peripheral displays. A peripheral display is assembled from modular support and electronic components without screws and cables to enable automated robotic manufacture, reuse and recycling.

(8) More specifically, an information handling system processes information with a processor and memory that is presented as visual images at a peripheral display. The peripheral display is assembled by sliding engagement of display assembly components, such as sliding a midplane having geometric structures onto a display panel back side with conforming slots to define a vertical space behind the display panel in which electronic components couple. A cover slidingly engages the midplane to couple over the electronic components and define a cavity in which the electronic components operate. The electronic components assemble in modular fashion to posts formed in the display panel back side and at adjacent positions where connectors on opposing edges of the electronic components contact to provide power and information communication without cables. EDID information is tracked on components and retrieved to scalar board that applies the EDID information to operate the electronic components in a cohesive manner. A modular input/output board enhances peripheral display functionality by including a scalar that takes over embedded scalar functions or, alternatively, by including EDID information available to the embedded scalar for use in peripheral display operations.

(9) The present invention provides a number of important technical advantages. One example of an important technical advantage is that a peripheral display is assembled with interchangeable modules that encourage reuse and recycling. The electronic components assemble to the display panel back side with sliding adjacent coupling arrangements that eliminate the use of cables between the components. A plastic midplane and cover couple to the backside to define a cavity that accepts the electronic components and separate at end of life into like-material portions to simplify recycling. Power is supplied in a flexible manner that can include integrated power conversion, an external power adapter and power transfer through a display cable. A power adapter frame included in the display panel cavity supports the reuse of information handling system power adapters within the display. Automated EDID management ensures that component assembly correctly adapts peripheral display operations to the selected components.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The present invention may be better understood, and its numerous objects, features and advantages made apparent to those skilled in the art by referencing the accompanying drawings. The use of the same reference number throughout the several figures designates a like or similar element.
- (2) FIG. 1 depicts a block diagram of an information handling system interfaced with a modular peripheral display that presents information as visual images;
- (3) FIG. 2 depicts a side perspective exploded view of the peripheral display structural elements that assemble in a sustainable manner without screws for improved assembly and end of life reuse and recycling;
- (4) FIG. 3 depicts a rear side view of a display panel back side configured to assemble into a display assembly in an automated manner;
- (5) FIG. 4 depicts a rear perspective exploded view of a midplane aligned to slidably couple in place at a back side of a display panel;
- (6) FIGS. 5A, 5B, 5C and 5D depict a rear view of a sliding engagement of the midplane and display panel rear side;
- (7) FIGS. 6A and 6B depict a rear view of a sliding assembly of a scalar board at the display panel rear side to directly interface with the timing controller board;
- (8) FIG. 7 depicts a side view with details of one example embodiment of a direct interface between a scalar board and a timing controller board;
- (9) FIGS. 8A and 8B depict a rear view of a sliding assembly of a power board at the display panel rear side to directly interface with the scalar board;
- (10) FIG. 9 depicts a side view with details of one example embodiment of a direct interface between a scalar board and a power board;
- (11) FIGS. 10A and 10B depict a rear perspective view of assembly of a riser board at the display panel rear side to directly interface with the scalar board;
- (12) FIG. 11 depicts a block diagram of logical elements that interface joystick inputs to an OSD menu presented at the display panel;
- (13) FIG. 12 depicts a rear perspective view of the display assembly with an example configuration of connection ports to accept power and information;
- (14) FIGS. 13 and 13A depict an example embodiment of tool-less attachment of the cover to the midplane to define a cavity at the display panel backside for assembly of electronic components;
- (15) FIGS. 14, 14A and 14B depict an example embodiment of a latch mechanism for securing the cover to the midplane in a releasable manner;
- (16) FIG. 15 depicts a rear perspective view of the display assembly having the cover removed and power automatically disabled;
- (17) FIGS. 16, 16A and 16B depict a detailed view of an example embodiment of the cut off switch;
- (18) FIG. 17 depicts an example embodiment of an external AC-to-DC power adapter coupled into the cavity defined between the display panel back side and cover as a power supply in the place of a power board;
- (19) FIG. 18 depicts a flow diagram of a process for dynamic power arbitration between an internal power board and an AC-to-DC power adapter;
- (20) FIG. 19 depicts a flow diagram of dynamic power allocation based upon an identified connected AC-to-DC power adapter;
- (21) FIG. 20 depicts a flow diagram of a process for maintaining an uninterrupted power supply at a peripheral display;

- (22) FIGS. 21A and 21B depict a block diagram of an alternative embodiment of a peripheral display having an external scalar in a modular input/output board;
- (23) FIGS. 22, 22A and 22B depict an example embodiment of a housing to support modular I/O board functionality; and
- (24) FIGS. 23A and 23B depict a block diagram of a scalar board and modular I/O board that dynamically configure display properties at a scalar with programmable EDID.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(25) An information handling system presents visual images at a modular peripheral display assembled with reusable components. For purposes of this disclosure, an information handling system may include any instrumentality or aggregate of instrumentalities operable to compute, classify, process, transmit, receive, retrieve, originate, switch, store, display, manifest, detect, record, reproduce, handle, or utilize any form of information, intelligence, or data for business, scientific, control, or other purposes. For example, an information handling system may be a personal computer, a network storage device, or any other suitable device and may vary in size, shape, performance, functionality, and price. The information handling system may include random access memory (RAM), one or more processing resources such as a central processing unit (CPU) or hardware or software control logic, ROM, and/or other types of nonvolatile memory. Additional components of the information handling system may include one or more disk drives, one or more network ports for communicating with external devices as well as various input and output (I/O) devices, such as a keyboard, a mouse, and a video display. The information handling system may also include one or more buses operable to transmit communications between the various hardware components.

(26) Referring now to FIG. 1, a block diagram depicts an information handling system **10** interfaced with a modular peripheral display **40** that presents information as visual images. A housing **12** contains processing components that cooperate to process information and can include stationary housings, such as for desktop or tower information handling systems, and portable housings, such as for convertible or tablet information handling systems. A central processing unit (CPU) **14** executes instructions that process information in cooperation with a random access memory (RAM) **16** that stores the instructions and information. A solid state drive (SSD) **18** provides persistent non-transitory memory that stores information when the system is powered down, such as an operating system and applications that are retrieved to RAM **16** by an embedded controller **20** when the system powers up. Embedded controller **20** manages system operating conditions, such as power and thermal operating conditions, and interactions with input/output devices, such as a keyboard and mouse to accept end user inputs. A graphics processing unit (GPU) **22** interfaces with CPU **14** to further process information into a format for presentation at a display panel, such as by defining a visual image as an array of pixel values. In the example embodiment, GPU **22** outputs the visual image information through a variety of different display cable ports, including a Type C USB port **22**, a DisplayPort port **34** and an HDMI port **36**. A power supply unit **24** supplies power for operation of the processing components, such as with power from an external AC power cord or a battery **26** that charges when power is available and discharges when power is not available. In example embodiment, PSU **24** and battery **26** support mobile operations for a portable information handling system. In an alternative embodiment, PSU **24** and battery **26** cooperate as an uninterruptable power supply (UPS) that keeps information handling system **10** operating when external power cuts off.

(27) In the example embodiment, information handling system **10** presents information as visual images at a peripheral display **40** by communicating the visual information from display cable ports **30** through display cable **38** to display cable ports of peripheral display **40**. A USB Hub **28** included in information handling system **10** includes a capability to communicate power between information handling system **10** and peripheral display **40**, such as in accordance with the USB Type C standard. Peripheral display **40** has a display assembly **44** that is held in a viewing position

by a display stand **42**. Display assembly **44** has a display panel **46** at a front face that has an array of pixels **48** configured to present visual images based upon pixel values communicated from GPU **22**. Peripheral display **40** is powered by one or both of an external AC power cord **174** that interfaces with an AC plug and an external AC-to-DC power adapter **170** that interfaces with a DC plug, such as a barrel connector or a USB Type C cable connector. In addition to the AC and DC plugs, peripheral display **40** may operate on power received from information handling system **10**, such as through a Type C USB cable connection power transfer. Power from information handling system **10** may be in addition to power from the AC and DC plugs or as a separate power source, such as a UPS from PSU **24** and battery **26** when other power provided to peripheral display **40** is cut off.

(28) Referring now to FIG. **2**, a side perspective exploded view of peripheral display **40** depicts structural elements that assemble in a sustainable manner without screws for improved assembly and end of life reuse and recycling. In the example embodiment, display assembly **44** includes a display panel **46** at a front face that presents visual images and is held at a viewing height by a stand **42** coupled to a stand support **54** that couples to a back side of display panel **46**. A midplane **50** couples around a perimeter of display panel **46** between the back side of display panel **46** and a cover **52** that encloses the back side of display assembly **44**. Peripheral display **40** is assembled to have the components breakdown by a material type or function. For example, midplane **50** and cover **52** are injection molded plastic that assemble and disassemble without screws to encourage recycling with an automated approach. Within the cavity defined by midplane **50** between the display panel back side and the cover, electronics assemble in a modular fashion to encourage interchangeability and with a lack of cables, as is described below in greater detail.

(29) Referring now to FIG. **3**, a rear side view depicts a display assembly **44** back side **56** configured to assemble into a display assembly in an automated manner. Slots **58** and **60** are formed in a metal plate of the back side to extend out and have an opening towards a top side of the display panel. In the example embodiment, the slots have a U shape with a taper from the opening to a base that accepts a geometric structure of a corresponding shape so that the shape readily inserts into the slot and has more tight fit as the shape is further inserted into the slot. In one embodiment, the positions of slots **58** and **60** may be spaced to ascertain the orientation of a midplane that couples to the slots. A timing controller board **62** is a PCB that supports a timing controller interfaced with pixels of the display panel **46** to scan pixel values to the pixels that define a visual image for presentation at the display panel. A variety of posts **64** and **66** are punched out of the display panel back side to extend outwards and accepts components, such as circuit boards, that couple to the display panel back side. A snap connector **61** is located at a bottom corner of the display panel back side to couple to a midplane when the midplane fully slides to a coupled position as depicted below. Snap connector **61** has a removable configuration that supports disassembly of the midplane by automated means, such as predetermined forces that overcomes the snap when applied by a robotic arm.

(30) Referring now to FIG. **4**, a rear perspective exploded view depicts a midplane **50** aligned to slidably couple in place at a back side of a display panel. Midplane **50** is injection molded plastic having geometric structures **66** and **64** shaped to fit into the slots punched out of the metal of the display panel back side. A snap **68** at a bottom corner is configured to engage the snap connector of the display panel back side when midplane **50** slides completely into position. Midplane **50** provides a separation of materials between the display panel and the electronic components at the display panel back side to delineate recyclable or reusable portions of the display. The side walls at the perimeter of midplane **50** define a vertical space behind the display panel to include the electronic components and provide an assembly surface to couple on a cover. By sliding midplane **50** onto the display panel from a top side towards a bottom side, the effect of gravity is to keep a secure attachment between the midplane and display panel after deployment as the weight of the display panel works to maintain a secure attachment of the geometric structures in the slots.

Although the example embodiment as explained below uses a U-shape geometric structure to obtain secure attachment and proper alignment, other types of geometric shapes may be used, such as a V shape or different types of shapes at different locations of the perimeter. In addition, midplane **50** includes tabs near each geometric structure that define a rail onto which a guide of a display panel rear cover can slide, as described in greater detail below.

(31) Referring now to FIGS. **5A**, **5B**, **5C** and **5D**, a rear view depicts a sliding engagement of the midplane and display panel rear side. In the example embodiment, each geometric structure **64** and **66** has an open space at a bottom side that provides space for placement of midplane **50** onto the display panel back side **56** at slots **58** and **60**. Once midplane **50** is aligned to slide onto display panel back side **56**, a sliding motion in the direction of arrow **70** engages the geometric structures **64** and **66** into the slots **58** and **60** so that the bottom side of midplane **50** slides over timing controller board **62** and the snap **68** engages with snap connector **61** to hold midplane **50** in place. FIG. **5C** depicts a detailed view of a geometric structure **64** that inserts into a slot **58** with corresponding U shapes so that the geometric shape achieves a tight fit to the slot upon completion of the sliding insertion. In the example embodiment, to allow some deviation from alignment in the manufacture process, the geometric structure may have some room to slide within the slot while a firm coupling together is provided with a tight fit in the Z axis perpendicular to the sliding direction. In order to attain a desired alignment of midplane **50** relative to the back side **56**, each corner geometric structure **66** and slot **60** has an alignment tab to guide the sliding assembly. In the example embodiment the alignment tab is a T-lock having a T-lock feature **72** raised relative to the back side of geometric structure **66** and fitting into a groove feature **74** cut into the chamfered punched material of the slot **60**. The T-lock engagement in the groove provides precise alignment defined after the punch process creates the slot to ensure that the outer perimeter of the display panel and midplane couple as an aesthetically pleasing assembly. In the example embodiment, the alignment tab feature is included in only the four corners of the assembly. The sliding engagement without any screws allows automated assembly processes, such as robotic handling, and ready disassembly at end of life for recycling and reuse.

(32) Referring now to FIGS. **6A** and **6B**, a rear view depicts a sliding assembly of a scalar board **76** at the display panel rear side to directly interface with the timing controller board **62**. Timing controller board **62** couples to the display panel rear bottom side to interface with display panel wire lines that communicate pixel values to the display panel pixels. Scalar board **76** has a scalar **78** integrated circuit that includes a processing resource to manage display operations. Scalar **78** accepts visual information from a display cable or other source and formats the visual information so that a timing controller integrated circuit can scan the pixel values to the array of pixels scaled to the display panel resolution. Scalar board **76** includes slots **82** that align with posts **64** so that the scalar board slides relative to the display panel back side **56** in the direction indicated by arrow **80**. In addition, posts **64** may provide alignment of the scalar by having a raised surface at each side of the scalar board to define the insertion position. FIG. **6B** depicts completion of the sliding movement to engage scalar board **76** against timing controller board **62** so that communication is provided through a direct interface of edge connectors on each board. Display cable connectors **84** of display cables **38** couple to display cable ports **30** that surface mount on scalar board **76** and interface with scalar **78**. The display cable connection provides communication of visual information and/or communication of power between an information handling system and the peripheral display.

(33) Referring now to FIG. **7**, a side view depicts details of one example embodiment of a direct interface between a scalar board **76** and a timing controller board **62**. In the example embodiment, scalar board has teardrop shaped slots **82** that accept a post at a larger circumference and hold the scalar board in position when the posts slide to the end of a smaller circumference portion. The fully installed position couples an M.2 edge connector **86** coupled at a bottom side of scalar board **76** to an M.2 edge connector portion **88** so that installation of scalar board **76** completes the logic

and power interface with the timing controller board **62** by a direct interface that does not use cables. In addition to communication of visual information from scalar **78** to a timing controller, the M.2 connector interface also communicates power between the boards. In one example embodiment, power is provided from a regulated power source to the scalar board and then communicated to the timing board. In alternative embodiments, power can be directed from the cable connector ports **30** and then distributed to the timing controller board and a power board as described below. In the example embodiment, an LCD display panel has a backlight **96** coupled to a bottom side that illuminates the LCD pixels to present visual images. Power provided from scalar board **76** to timing controller board **62** is communicated to the backlight by a direct interface having a spring-biased connector **90**, such as pogo pins **92**, aligned with contact pads **94** of the backlight **96**. The direct interface by proximity of the boards supports power transfer without cables, also improving manufacturing, reuse and recycling of the scalar board, timing board and backlight. Although the example embodiment depicts an LCD display panel that is illuminated by a backlight, alternative embodiments may have an OLED display panel that does not use a backlight so that spring-biased connector may be left unpopulated. In an alternative embodiment, the spring-biased connector may couple to the scalar board and extend from the scalar board down to the backlight so that power is transferred directly from the scalar board to the backlight instead of through the timing controller board.

(34) Referring now to FIGS. **8A** and **8B**, a rear view depicts a sliding assembly of a power board **100** at the display panel rear side to directly interface with the scalar board **76**. In the example embodiment, power board **100** has an AC-to-DC adapter **104** and an uninterruptable power supply (UPS) **106**. AC-to-DC adapter **104** accepts external AC power through an AC plug **102** and converts the AC power to a regulated DC power that supplies the electronic components of the peripheral display. In one alternative embodiment, power board **100** may also have a DC power connector plug, such as a barrel connector port or a Type C USB connector port, so that an external DC adapter can also be used to power the peripheral display. UPS **106** includes a processing resource and battery that will operate the peripheral display for a limited time in the event of a sudden power loss. In alternative embodiments, the battery may be coupled to the display panel rear side and interfaced by a power port with the power board so that the UPS processing resource can quickly adapt to a power loss by providing power from the battery. Power board **100** has a power socket **108** coupled at a bottom side that aligns with a power connector **110** of scalar board **76** so that a sliding motion of power board **100** down against scalar board **76** as shown by arrow **112** inserts pins out of power connector **110** into power socket **108**. Once power board **100** directly interfaces with scalar **76**, power transfers from power board **100** through scalar **76** and timing controller board **62** to backlight **96** as described above without any cable connections.

(35) Referring now to FIG. **9**, a side view depicts details of one example embodiment of a direct interface between a scalar board **76** and a power board **100**. In the example embodiment, scalar board **76** and power board **100** each have teardrop shaped slots **82** that accept a post **84** at a larger circumference and hold the board in position when the posts slide to the end of a smaller circumference portion of the slot. Scalar board **76** couples to the display panel back side first followed by a sliding engagement of power board **100** so that power plug **116** with power connectors **110** inserts into power plug **108**. Insertion of the pin configuration of power connectors **110** into the socket helps to ensure that power is not available from power board contacts that are exposed without a scalar connected in place, such as if AC power couples to AC connector **102**. At one side of scalar board **76** an extension **112** is formed in the board to align with a snap connector **114** that snaps into place a full insertion of the scalar board slots onto the posts. Other types of snaps or locks may be used to ensure that the circuit boards remain in position once slid onto the posts. Snap connectors and similar tool-less coupling devices remove the need for securing boards in place with screws, thereby improving assembly and disassembly efficiency and enabling the use of automated assembly and disassembly, such as robotic tools.

(36) Referring now to FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, a rear perspective view depicts assembly of a riser board **120** at the display panel rear side to directly interface with the scalar board **76**. In the example embodiment, riser board **120** includes a five-position joystick **126** that extends downward to be exposed at the outer housing of the peripheral display for accepting end user inputs to manage peripheral display functions through an onscreen display menu (OSD). FIG. **10A** depicts insertion of riser board **120** perpendicular to scalar board **76** so that a logic plug **122** of riser board **120** inserts into a plug **124** surface mounted to scalar board **76**. FIG. **10B** depicts riser board **120** coupled into place so that the bottom side of the riser board rests against the bottom of scalar board **76** to help withstand inputs made at joystick **126**. Other supports, such as a snap coupler at the bottom surface of the riser board, can offer additional support to withstand inputs at the joystick. In the example embodiment, a post **84** bent up from the display backside rests against a vertical side of scalar board **76** to help maintain the scalar board position and also guide the scalar board during sliding coupling with the display panel back side.

(37) Referring now to FIG. **11**, a block diagram depicts logical elements that interface joystick inputs to an OSD menu presented at the display panel. In the example embodiment, joystick **126** interfaces with scalar **78** to accept end user inputs at the display to manage display operating conditions, such as brightness, contrast, input source and other selectable operating conditions. Scalar **78** is a processing resource that executes instructions of an OSD module **140** stored in a flash memory **142** or other non-transitory memory. Scalar **78** presents an OSD menu **146** at display panel **46** based upon the inputs made to joystick **126**.

(38) Referring now to FIG. **12**, a rear perspective view of the display assembly depicts an example configuration of connection ports to accept power and information. In the example embodiment, a cover **52** of injection molded plastic couples to midplane **50** to define a cavity at the back side of display panel **44** where the electronic components are coupled as described above. Power AC cable port **102** is exposed to accept an AC power cord that provides power from an AC socket for use by the power board. At a rear side of cover **52** plural display cable ports are exposed to accept display cables, including a DisplayPort ports **130**, HDMI ports **132**, and Type C USB ports **134**, each of which surface mounts to the scalar board as described above. Along the bottom side of cover **52**, additional display cable ports **136** are exposed as is joystick **126**. The example embodiment depicts the cable ports as exposed at openings of cover **52**, however, in alternative embodiments, some or all of the cable ports may be exposed at openings of midplane **50**.

(39) Referring now to FIGS. **13** and **13A**, an example embodiment depicts tool-less attachment of the cover to the midplane to define a cavity at the display panel backside for assembly of electronic components. In the example embodiment, cover **52** slides relative to midplane **50** and back side **56** to enclose and expose electronic components coupled in the cavity defined between cover **52** and back side **56**. Stand support **54** snaps to back side **56** over the power board to offer a VESA standard coupling arrangement of the display assembly to the display stand. In the example embodiment, cover **52** slides with respect to midplane **50** through a rail and guide structure **150** and **152** as detailed in FIG. **13A**. In one embodiment, guide structure **150** coupled to midplane **50** are tabs that extend out at each geometric structure. When cover **52** slides to full engaged position so that a snap and snap connector lock in place, the top and bottom edges align with the top and bottom edges of midplane **50** to give an aesthetically pleasing but readily disassembled solution so that automated techniques may be used and end of life, such as robotic arms.

(40) Referring now to FIGS. **14**, **14A** and **14B**, an example embodiment depicts a latch mechanism for securing the cover to the midplane in a releasable manner. FIG. **14** depicts a rear perspective view of the display assembly having a release handle **156** pressed at the bottom side of cover **52** to release the cover to slide free as indicated by arrow **154**. FIG. **14A** depicts a sectional view of midplane **50** having the right side latch mechanism to hold cover **52** in place and FIG. **14B** depicts midplane **50** having the left side latch mechanism. Release handle **156** presses down to move a latch **158** at a midway point of the handle so that the latch **158** releases from a member within

cover **52**. When latch **158** presses to a released position, cover **52** slides to remove from the display assembly rear side. When release handle **156** is let go, it biases upward to a latch position so that latch **158** engages with the cover to hold the cover in place. During sliding assembly of cover **52**, latch **158** yields to the internal member on the cover and then snaps into place when the cover fully slides into position. FIG. **14B** depicts the left side release handle **156** positioned over scalar board **76** and displaced from joystick **126** and riser board **120** so as not to interfere with display operations in either the released or latched positions. In one example embodiment, pressing release handle **156** may turn off power at the display as described below.

(41) Referring now to FIG. **15**, a rear perspective view depicts the display assembly having the cover removed and power automatically disabled. In the example embodiment, cover **52** is positioned to insert onto midplane **50** and slide to enclose the display assembly electronic components. Scalar board **76** is positioned at the bottom side of the display assembly to expose display cable connector ports. Stand support **54** couples in place over power board **100** to align with a central region of cover **52** where a VESA display stand can couple into place. AC power connector **102** is exposed at the bottom side of stand support **54** and aligned with an opening of cover **52** to accept an AC power plug. A power cut off switch **160** is located at an opening of stand support **54** and aligned to accept a member of cover **52** when cover **52** slides into position. When cut off switch **160** is activated, power is available from power board **100**. When cut off switch **160** is not activated power is turned off at power board **100** so that the electronic components will not receive power. In one embodiment, cut off switch **160** is a mechanical switch activated by a physical member of cover **52** that contacts the mechanical switch when cover **52** is slid fully on. In another embodiment, cut off switch **160** is a Hall sensor that is activated when a magnet coupled to cover **52** is proximate the Hall sensor at full insertion of cover **52** on midplane **50**.

(42) Referring now to FIGS. **16**, **16A** and **16B**, a detailed view of an example embodiment of the cut off switch is depicted. In the example embodiment, cut off switch **160** is a mechanical switch biased to an open position when the cover is removed so that power input at AC cable port **102** will not be available from power board **100** for use in electronic components of the display assembly. FIG. **16A** depicts power board **100** having an AC-to-DC converter **104**, a UPS **106** and a processing resource **162** that manages operation of the power components. Cut off switch **160** interfaces with processing resource **162**, such as microcontroller unit (MCU), so that the open position is detected to turn off power supply from the AC-to-DC converter and UPS and thereby prevent availability of power at power socket **108**. FIG. **16B** depicts a side sectional view of cover **52** assembled over the power board so that a member **164** of cover **52** presses down on and closes cut off switch **160**, thereby enabling power distribution from the power board out of the power socket.

(43) Referring now to FIG. **17**, an example embodiment depicts an external AC-to-DC power adapter **170** coupled into the cavity defined between the display panel back side **56** and cover as a power supply in the place of a power board. A frame **172** engages with AC-to-DC power adapter **170** to hold it in position so that an AC power cord **174** can insert through cover into a power connector of the adapter. A power cable **176** terminating in a power connector **178**, such as a Type C USB or barrel connector, communicates power and power adapter information to a power connector port **180** surface mounted to scalar board **76**, such as a Type C USB cable port or a barrel connector port. AC-to-DC power adapter **170** is packaged for external use, such as with a convertible information handling system, and provides a variety of different power configurations, such as 45 W, 65 W, 90 W, 100 W, 130 W, 240 W and 360 W. Inclusion of a power adapter packaged for external use and having variable amounts of power output supports recycling of power adapters used for information handling systems at end of life of the information handling systems since power adapters tend to have an extended useful life. The different power configurations are supported with communication by the power adapter of its output, such as with Type C USB standard power configurations or barrel connector PSID communications commonly

used by portable information handling systems when interfacing with external power adapters. In the example embodiment, a processing resource on scalar board **76**, such as the scalar or a dedicated MCU or USB hub, manages distribution of the regulated power supply from the power adapter to the timing controller, backlight and other display assembly power components. A UPS **106** interfaces with scalar board **76** to initiate power from a battery in the event power is cut off from the power adapter.

(44) In one alternative embodiment, multiple power sources are available to provide power to the display assembly and also support power distribution to external devices, such as an information handling system or peripherals that couple to a Type C USB power port connector of scalar board **76**. For example, a display assembly can include AC-to-DC power adapter **170** as shown, a power board that has an AC-to-DC power adapter as described above and/or an external DC supply communicated through a Type C USB and/or barrel plug connector to the scalar board. When multiple DC power sources are available, a processing resource of the display assembly, such as the scalar and/or an MCU on the scalar board and/or power board, detects the DC power sources, identifies the capabilities of the DC power sources and arbitrates use of available power to achieve desired goals, such as efficiency and power supply to external devices. In one embodiment, logic stored in non-transitory memory of the scalar arbitrates between two or more AC-to-DC adapter power sources based upon the presence of the power sources and the efficiency of the power sources. For instance, the power source that is most efficient for a given display power use is selected as the power source to provide power to the scalar board. The efficiency of the power adapters may be tracked with empirical data stored in the non-transitory memory to aid in selection of the power source that is most efficient for a given power configuration. The power configuration may change based upon the interface of external devices to the peripheral display that draw power from the peripheral display, such as an information handling system interfaced through a Type C USB cable. As an example, a typical 27 inch peripheral display draws a maximum of 130 W and supplies 65 W to 100 W out a Type C cable connector. Logic executing on the scalar or an MCU of the power board reads the amount of power available from each DC power source and selects one or more of the DC power sources based upon power draw, to ensure that enough power is available for the detected configuration, and efficiency, to ensure that of the available DC power sources for the detected power draw, the most efficient power source is used. If the power draw exceeds the power available from any one DC power source, then multiple DC power sources may be used, such as by assigning one DC power source to power display components and another DC power source to power external devices.

(45) Referring now to FIG. **18**, a flow diagram depicts a process for dynamic power arbitration between an internal power board and an AC-to-DC power adapter. The process starts at step **190** and at step **192** determines if a power board is present in the display. If a power board is not present, the process continues to step **196** to determine if a DC power source is plugged into the peripheral display. If the DC power source is plugged in, the process continues to step **200** to use the DC power source to power the display as the only detected power source. If at step **192** a power board is present, the process continues to step **194** to determine if DC power is plugged in and available from the AC-to-DC power adapter in addition to the power board. If the power adapter is not plugged in, the process continues to step **200** to use the power board adapter as the DC power source. If at step **194** both the power board and the AC-to-DC power adapter are available, the process continues to step **198** to determine which power source has the best efficiency, such as based upon an identifier retrieved from the AC-to-DC power adapter. At step **202** the power board is used as the most efficient power source, although in various embodiments with different configurations, the AC-to-DC power adapter may be selected as the more efficient power source. The process returns to step **190** when a change is detected in the available power sources or power draws to select the best power source alternative.

(46) Referring now to FIG. **19**, a flow diagram depicts dynamic power allocation based upon an

identified connected AC-to-DC power adapter. The process starts at step **210** and at step **212** determines the power adapter's maximum power output, such as by reading a PSID value or a USB Type C standard power value. At step **214**, a comparison of the available power from the power source and the power draw of the display is performed to determine if the power source can support full display power draw. If yes, the process continues to step **216** to enable all display features and returns to step **210** to reevaluate the power conditions if available power of power draw change, such as by interfacing additional power adapters or external devices that draw power. If at step **214** the power source cannot support full display power draw, the process continues to step **218** to determine if the power source available power meets at least the power draw needs of the scalar, timing controller and minimum backlight brightness. If the minimum power draw is not supported, the process continues to step **220** to issue an adapter error and returns to step **210**. If the minimum power draw is available at step **218**, the process continues to step **222** to determine if the full backlight brightness is supported by the power source. If not the process continues to step **224** to reduce the backlight brightness range to operate with the available power and the process returns to step **210**. If the full backlight brightness is available at step **222**, the process continues to step **226** to determine if a full amount of USB power out is supported out by the power source. If not, the process continues to step **228** to determine the maximum USB power limit and at step **230** advertises that limit to external devices that interface with the peripheral display USB power connectors. In one alternative embodiment, if the detected USB devices request power draw of less than the full amount, extra power available may be reserved for other uses, such as to increase backlight brightness. If at step **226** the full USB power out is available, the process continues to step **232** to enable all features and then returns to step **210** to monitor for changes in the amount of available power or the amount of power drawn by external devices.

(47) Referring now to FIG. **20**, a flow diagram depicts a process for maintaining an uninterrupted power supply at a peripheral display. The process starts at step **240** and at step **242** determines if the main power supply is available. If so, the process continues to step **246** to power the display from the power source and determine if a most efficient power supply is available. If the main power source is not available, the process continues to step **244** to determine if a DC power supply is available, such as an external AC-to-DC power adapter. If yes, the process continues to step **246** as before. If both power sources are not available due to a power cut off or failure, the process continues to step **248** to power the display from the uninterruptible power supply. Typically the battery will provide sufficient power for a temporary operation so that a notice of the UPS use is published along with an expected power time when the failure is detected. In one alternative embodiment, the UPS may include an external battery power source that feeds into a power plug connector, such as a Type C USB connector. For example, a battery of a portable information handling system may reverse from charging through a display USB cable to discharging so that the display has power to operate. Logic on the scalar may also revert the display to a low power consumption mode by setting a reduced brightness and scan rate when the power cut off is detected.

(48) Referring now to FIGS. **21A** and **21B**, a block diagram depicts an alternative embodiment of a peripheral display having an external scalar in a modular input/output board. In the example embodiment, scalar board **76** couples in the display assembly as described above and a modular input/output (I/O) board **260** interfaces with scalar board **76** through a connector board from exterior to the display assembly, such as in a modular housing located outside of the cavity defined by the cover and display panel back side. Scalar board **76** has a scalar **78** that processes visual information received from various visual information sources, such as DisplayPort inputs **258** that are managed by DisplayPort re-drivers **254**. A Type C USB power driver **256** manages power accepted from and provided to an external source. Scalar **78** in the example embodiment operates based upon system component information stored in Extended Display Identification Data (EDID) non-transitory memory. Scalar **78** provides visual information for presentation at the display panel

to timing controller board **62** having a timing controller **250** that scans the visual information to display panel pixels according to EDID system component information. Scalar **78** is the primary processing resource for the display and includes a DDRS non-transitory memory to store instructions executed by scalar **78**.

(49) Modular I/O board **260** supplements the operation of a display by coupling to a display cable communication port to interface with scalar board **76** so that a scalar **78** on the modular I/O board can take over the scalar functions performed by the scalar on scalar board **76** and prioritize scalar functions. The modular I/O board offers a boost to performance of a display assembly with a more powerful scalar that supports additional functionality and input/output device ports. In the example embodiment, modular I/O board **260** includes three display cable communication ports **30** that accept USB 3.0 Type A and Type C connectors. These ports interface through a USB hub **264** and with a Type C controller **261** that manages port functions with instructions stored in an SPI flash **262** of non-transitory memory. Scalar **78** interfaces with the USB hub through a USB 3.0 re-driver **270** and also interfaces with other inputs, including HDMI inputs **272** and Type C inputs **274**. Scalar **78** of modular I/O board **260** communicates with scalar board **76** through a DisplayPort re-drive **254** and provides power by a USB Type C interface. This interface allows the module I/O board scalar to command operations by the scalar board **76** scalar and thereby manage presentation of visual information by timing controller **250**.

(50) In the example embodiment, one additional function supported by the modular I/O board is presentation of audible information through an audio codec **266** and speakers **268**. In such an embodiment, the speaker housing not only includes speakers but hardware and logic to manage presentation of visual information that improves an end user experience for presentation of audiovisual information. The example embodiment also supports other types of functions based upon hardware capabilities included in the speaker housing. For instance, a keyboard, video, mouse (KVM) switch is supported with logic that executes on the Type C controller to direct keyboard and mouse inputs at the USB ports to a selected of plural information handling systems interfaced with Type C USB ports. Alternative embodiments might include wireless communication capabilities, television receiver capabilities or other types of network communication capabilities that supplement the operation of the display panel.

(51) Referring now to FIGS. **22**, **22A** and **22B**, an example embodiment of a housing to support modular I/O board functionality is depicted. FIG. **22** depicts a front view of a peripheral display **40** having a modular speaker housing **280** that includes speakers **268** and display cable communication ports **30**. FIG. **22** depicts modular housing **280** aligned to couple to peripheral display **40** with magnet extensions **284** that insert in cavities **292** having a ferromagnetic frame material. A Type C USB communication port **292** at the bottom surface of peripheral display **40** interfaces with a Type C USB connector **288** extending out of the top side **282** of modular speaker housing **280** as shown in FIG. **22B**. Magnets **286** are shown in magnet extensions **284** placed in close proximity to a metal frame of the peripheral display. Once the Type C USB connector inserts into the Type C USB port, the scalar in the modular I/O board receives power and interfaces with the peripheral display board to take over scalar duties and enable speaker operations as described above.

(52) Referring now to FIGS. **23A** and **23B**, a block diagram of a scalar board and modular I/O board is depicted that dynamically configure display properties at a scalar with programmable EDID. In the example embodiment, modular I/O board **260** is configured to couple in the speaker of FIG. **22** to present audio information with codec **266** and support communications through display cable ports **30** with Hub **264**, Type C interfaces **274**, HDMI interfaces **272** and other interfaces as desired. Modular I/O board Type C controller **260** and instructions in SPI flash **262** coordinate operations through a Type C crossbar **290**. Unlike the embodiment of FIG. **21**, the modular I/O board **260** does not include a scalar and instead coordinates scalar operations through USB re-driver **270** and **254** with HDMI input directed to the scalar **78**. In one embodiment, audio received at the modular I/O board is played directly by the codec while visual information

continues to the scalar board for processing. Alternatively, the scalar board performs processing of audiovisual information and returns audio information to the audio codec for output as sounds by the speaker. The modular approach of modular I/O board **260** adds a flexibility that improves an end user experience and selectively enhances peripheral display capabilities. However, the peripheral display itself takes a modular approach with standardized interfaces so that a variety of different hardware elements may be included at assembly of the display based upon availability and selectively enhanced after assembly with modular I/O capabilities. In particular, the modular approach enhances component reuse where components that have an extended usable life can be reused in new and rebuilt peripheral displays. In order to coordinate the interaction of modular components, an I/O EDID memory **296**, power EDID memory **298**, timing controller EDID memory **300** and scalar EDID memory **252** adjust after peripheral display assembly to adapt to detected components, such as by storing EDID on the scalar board for detected components. In one example embodiment, scalar **78** executes instructions stored in DDR3 non-transitory memory to retrieve and track EDID information and ensure proper operation of the peripheral display. In the example embodiment, the modular I/O board communicates EDID to the scalar for application. When the modular I/O board includes a scalar, the modular I/O board leverages the scalar board to retrieve EDID and apply the EDID to control the scalar of the scalar board.

(53) EDID settings stored in the non-transitory EDID memories are dynamically adjusted based upon the paired scalar and display module. Conventional EDID information is stored in ROM at display assembly, generally on the scalar board so that at power up the EDID information is read and applied to configure various parameters to drive the display. Parameters managed with EDID information include input type (digital/analog), color bit depth, bit format (RGB 4:4:4; YCrCb 4:4:4; etc.), video interface (HDMI, DisplayPort, DVI, etc.), screen size/resolution, and supported frame rates. Conventional peripheral displays fix these values at manufacture by hardcoding the values in ROM. The present disclosure proposes a modular component assembly in which EDID information and display operational parameters can change to support multiple display modules, scalars and power sources that are dynamically adjusted when modules are selected for assembly or to swap out during upgrading, reuse or recycling at end of life. In one example embodiment, the detection scheme splits EDID ROM into two sections, one on the scalar board that stores scalar parameters and another on the display panel that stores display module related parameters, such as on the timing controller board. On power up, the scalar detects the EDID information to populate locally and manage operation of the component. This approach can adjust to different power sources by including EDID information in the power source and to modular I/O boards by storing EDID information on the modular board. Where the modular board includes a scalar, the modular board scalar can retrieve the EDID information of other components. Where the modular board does not include a scalar, the scalar board can retrieve the EDID information from the modular board and adjust operations accordingly. As an alternative, a processing resource and non-transitory memory may be embedded in the display panel, such as at the timing controller board, to include a lookup table that determines each parameter. This can be an analog voltage level or a discrete strapping scheme for each parameter or a combination of voltage levels and a strapping scheme. The scalar board assembles the EDID information for detected modules and stores the EDID information in EDID non-transitory memory. When a component change is detected, the EDID information is updated to maintain proper peripheral display operation as the system is updated, repaired or rebuilt.

(54) Although the present invention has been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, substitutions and alterations can be made hereto without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. An information handling system comprising: a housing; a processor coupled in the housing and operable to execute instructions that process information; a memory coupled in the housing and interfaced with the processor, the memory operable to store the instructions and information; a peripheral display external the housing and interfaced with the processor to present the information as visual images, the peripheral display having a display panel with an array of pixels to present the visual image, a timing board having a timing controller interfaced with the array of pixels to scan visual image values to the pixels, and a scalar board interfaced with the timing controller board, the scalar board having a first scalar interfaced with the timing controller and configured to control display panel visual image presentation; and a modular scalar board configured to selectively couple to the peripheral display and separate from the peripheral display, the modular scalar board having a second scalar configured to interface with the timing controller through the scalar board to control display panel visual image presentation instead of the first scalar when the modular scalar board couples to the peripheral display.
2. The information handling system of claim 1 further comprising: one or more display cable ports coupled to the scalar board and configured to accept visual information from a display cable for presentation by the first scalar at the display panel; wherein the modular scalar board couples to the scalar board through the one or more display cable ports.
3. The information handling system of claim 2 wherein the one or more display ports comprise a Type C USB port, the modular scalar board having a Type C USB connector coupled at one side to insert into the Type C USB port.
4. The information handling system of claim 2 further comprising plural display cable ports coupled to the modular scalar board and configured to accept visual information for presentation at the display panel.
5. The information handling system of claim 2 further comprising: a first non-transitory memory coupled to the scalar board storing extended display identification data (EDID) of the peripheral display; and a second non-transitory memory coupled to the modular scalar and storing instructions that when executed on the second scalar retrieves the EDID from the scalar board and applies the EDID to control presentation of the visual images at the display panel.
6. The information handling system of claim 5 further comprising instructions stored in the first non-transitory memory that when executed on the first scalar discovers components included in the peripheral display and stores the components in as EDID.
7. The information handling system of claim 2 further comprising: a modular housing separate from the peripheral display, the modular scalar board coupled in the modular housing and having a display connector extending from one side to couple with the one or more display cable ports; and an input/output component coupled in the modular housing configured to perform an input/output function in cooperation with the peripheral display and modular scalar board.
8. The information handling system of claim 7 wherein the input/output component comprises a speaker configured to output audio information.
9. The information handling system of claim 7 wherein the input/output component comprises a keyboard, video, mouse (KVM) switch.
10. A method for presenting visual images at a peripheral display, the method comprising: receiving visual information at a first port coupled to a scalar board; communicating the visual information with a first scalar of the scalar board to a timing controller to present the visual information as visual images at a display panel; detecting an interface of a modular scalar board with the scalar board; and in response to the detecting, controlling the communicating of the visual information with a second scalar coupled to the modular scalar board instead of the first scalar.
11. The method of claim 10 further comprising: receiving visual information at a second port coupled to the modular scalar board; and communicating the visual information with the second scalar to the timing controller through the scalar board.

12. The method of claim 11 further comprising: coupling the modular scalar board in a speaker housing; and coupling the speaker housing to the peripheral display to interface the modular scalar board with the scalar board.
 13. The method of claim 12 further comprising: presenting audio information received at the second port with the second scalar interfaced directly to the speaker; and presenting visual information associated with the audio information by communicating the visual information through the scalar board to the timing controller.
 14. The method of claim 13 further comprising: storing EDID of the peripheral display in non-transitory memory of the scalar board; and retrieving the EDID to the modular scalar board to apply when the second scalar controls the first scalar.
 15. The method of claim 11 further comprising playing audio at a speaker coupled to the modular scalar board.
 16. The method of claim 15 further comprising providing a keyboard, video, mouse (KVM) switch with the second scalar and plural ports of the modular scalar board.
 17. A peripheral display comprising: a housing; a display panel coupled in the housing and having an array of pixels to present information as visual images; a timing board coupled in the housing and having a timing controller interfaced with the array of pixels to scan visual image values to the pixels; a scalar board coupled in the housing and interfaced with the timing controller board, the scalar board having a first scalar interfaced with the timing controller and configured to control display panel visual image presentation; and a modular scalar board configured to selectively couple to the housing and separate from the housing, the modular scalar board having a second scalar configured to interface with the timing controller through the scalar board to control display panel visual image presentation instead of the first scalar when the modular scalar board couples to the peripheral display.
 18. The peripheral display of claim 17 further comprising: one or more display cable ports coupled to the scalar board and configured to accept visual information from a display cable for presentation by the first scalar at the display panel; wherein the modular scalar board couples to the scalar board through the one or more display cable ports.
 19. The peripheral display of claim 18 further comprising: a modular housing separate from the peripheral display, the modular scalar board coupled in the modular housing and having a display connector extending from one side to couple with the one or more display cable ports; and an input/output component coupled in the modular housing configured to perform an input/output function in cooperation with the peripheral display and modular scalar board.
 20. The peripheral display of claim 19 wherein the input/output component comprises a speaker interfaced with the scalar and operable to present audio information as sounds associated with visual images presented by the second scalar at the display panel.
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